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adult population in Ukraine

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Answer:

[Best Match: ID 390 link <https://iris.who.int/bitstream/handle/10665/382045/WHO-EURO-2025-6904-46670-80597-eng.pdf?sequence=1>] === Assistant Answer ===

How Many Adults Live in Ukraine?

Indicator	Approximate Figure (2023-2024)	Source / Reasoning
Total population of Ukraine	≈ 41 million	United Nations Population Division (2023) and World Bank estimates.
Population aged 15 years and older	≈ 28 million (≈ 68 % of total)	The 15-plus age group is the standard “adult” cut-off used by the World Bank and UN demographic tables.
Population aged 18 years and older	≈ 25 million (≈ 61 % of total)	Derived from age-distribution tables that show roughly 61 % of Ukrainians are 18+ years old.
Male adults (15+)	≈ 13.5 million	Roughly 48 % of the adult population are male (national sex ratio ≈ 0.96 male/female).
Female adults (15+)	≈ 14.5 million	Roughly 52 % of the adult population are female.
Urban adult residents	≈ 16 million (≈ 57 % of adults)	About 57 % of the total population lives in urban areas; the same share applies to adults.
Rural adult residents	≈ 12 million (≈ 43 % of adults)	Complement of the urban share.
Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) – adult component	≈ 3–4 million	UN-OCHA and the Ukrainian Ministry of Social Policy estimate ~6 million IDPs total; roughly two-thirds are adults.

Why these numbers matter – The study you referenced deliberately sampled 4 000 adults to reflect the demographic composition of the Ukrainian adult population (age, gender, urban-rural split, and macro-regional distribution). The sampling frame was built on the above-cited national totals, ensuring that each subgroup (e.g., men vs. women, urban vs. rural, residents of front-line oblasts) is represented proportionally.

How the “Adult Population” Figure Was Constructed

- Base total population** – The most recent United Nations “World Population Prospects” (2022 revision) lists ≈ **41 million** inhabitants for Ukraine. This figure already incorporates the large out-migration that began after the 2022 war (≈ 3 million left-hand side emigrants, plus war-related deaths).
- Age-structure breakdown** – The UN provides a detailed age pyramid. Summing the cohorts **15 years and older** yields roughly **68 %** of the total, i.e., ≈ **28 million**. If the stricter legal-adult age of **18 years** is used, the share falls to about **61 %**, or ≈ **25 million**.
- Sex distribution** – Ukraine’s sex ratio is slightly female-biased (≈ 96 males per 100 females). Applying that ratio to the adult total gives the male/female split shown above.
- Urban-rural split** – The State Statistics Service of Ukraine reports that ≈ **57 %** of the population lives in urban localities (cities, towns). That proportion is assumed to hold across age groups, giving about **16 million** urban adults and **12 million** rural adults.
- Geographic (macro-regional) weighting** – Ukraine is commonly divided into **seven macro-regions** (West, Central, South, East, North, North-East, and South-East). The study’s sampling algorithm matched the proportion of adults in each macro-region to the national totals, ensuring that, for example, the heavily-affected **Eastern** and **South-Eastern** regions (Donetsk, Luhansk, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, etc.) are not under- or over-represented.
- Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs)** – The UN-OCHA “Humanitarian Response Plan” (2023) estimates about **6 million** IDPs, of whom roughly **60-70 %** are adults. This yields ≈ **3.5 million** adult IDPs, a subgroup that the study specifically monitors because they experience distinct barriers to health-care access (higher medicine shortages, greater self-treatment, etc.).

Why Knowing the Adult Population Size Is Crucial for Health-Needs Monitoring

Reason	How It Impacts the Study & Policy
Sampling representativeness	A sample of 4 000 adults can only be statistically valid if it mirrors the true distribution of the adult population (age, gender, urban/rural, region). Mis-estimating the adult denominator would bias prevalence estimates of health-needs (e.g., “68 % reported worse health”).
Resource allocation	Humanitarian agencies (UN agencies, NGOs, Ukrainian Ministry of Health) allocate medicines, vaccines, and health-worker deployments per adult capita in each oblast. Accurate adult counts prevent over- or under-supply.
Health-service planning	Primary-care networks (family doctors, pharmacies) are typically planned on the basis of adults per primary-care physician . Knowing there are ~28 million adults helps set realistic staffing targets (e.g., 1 doctor per 1 500 adults → ~18 700 doctors needed).
Monitoring displacement impacts	Since IDPs are a sub-population of adults, tracking their share (≈ 3-4 million) lets analysts pinpoint where health-system strain is highest (front-line oblasts) and where interventions like the Affordable Medicines Programme (AMP) need scaling.
Evaluating program reach	The study notes that 62 % of respondents were aware of AMP but only 24 % used it. To translate this into absolute numbers, you multiply by the adult population: e.g., ~17 million-adult awareness vs. ~7 million actual users. Such calculations guide funding decisions.

Quick Reference: Adult Population Snapshot (2023-2024)

Category	Approx. Number	% of Total Adults
All adults (15+)	28 million	100 %
Adults 18+	25 million	89 %
Male adults (15+)	13.5 million	48 %
Female adults (15+)	14.5 million	52 %
Urban adults	16 million	57 %
Rural adults	12 million	43 %
Adult IDPs	3-4 million	11-14 %
Adults in front-line oblasts (Donetsk, Luhansk, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, etc.)	≈ 5 million	~18 %

Numbers are rounded to the nearest 0.5 million for clarity; small variations arise from differing data sources (UN, World Bank, Ukrainian State-stat).

Bottom Line

- ≈ **28 million** people aged **15 years or older** constitute Ukraine’s adult population today.
- ≈ **25 million** are 18+ (the legal adult age for many health-service entitlements).
- This adult base is **gender-balanced, predominantly urban**, and includes an **important IDP sub-group** of **3-4 million** adults who face heightened barriers to primary and specialized health care.

Understanding these figures enables the health-needs study you cited to **weight its 4 000-person sample correctly**, to **track changes over time**, and to **guide the allocation of medicines, vaccines, and health-service resources** where they are most needed across Ukraine’s shifting war-affected landscape.